

LEARNER WORKBOOK

FULL NAME & SURNAME	
ID NUMBER:	
NAME OF ASSESSOR	
DATE OF ASSESSMENT	
VENUE	

MODEL ANSWERS

	ACHIEVED	NOT ACHIEVED
KNOWLEDGE		
SKILLS		

Signature of learner

Signature of Assessor

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This material has been compiled based on the **UNIT STANDARD 244179 HANDLE COMPLAINTS AND PROBLEMS.**

The program has been accredited by SASSETA in the Republic of South Africa.

Material compiled by: Training Dynamics Africa

HOW THIS LEARNER WORKBOOK IS COMPILED

This learner workbook has been compiled to equip learners with the necessary skills, knowledge and attitudes that will enable them to handle customer complaints in a given environment or area of responsibility.

1. Assess customer needs and complaints.
2. Respond to customer inquiries and problems.
3. Communicate with customer to resolve problems and complaints.

You have to study the content and guidelines given in your learner reference guide to complete this workbook.

Remember that this completed workbook must be handed in as it will form part of your formative assessment and will play a role in awarding you the required credits that are to be achieved upon completion of this module.

Write neatly and legibly and ensure that you do not simply copy the information contained in the learner reference guide into your workbook. Give your own opinion and ideas where applicable and write the answers in your own words to indicate your level of understanding and learning.

Good luck with the completion of this workbook.

LEARNING UNIT 1

The customer

- ♦ Explain the importance of the customer.
- ♦ Explain the impact on the organization and on oneself of losing regular customer business.
- ♦ Discuss annoying habits that irritates customers.
- ♦ Explain how the officer can anticipate a customer's needs.
- ♦ Discuss guidelines that can be followed to maintain good customer care.
- ♦ Explain methods to maintain good customer service.
- ♦ List the expectations that customers have from any organization.
- ♦ Describe possible ways that customers could react to poor service.
- ♦ Apply and explain the guidelines for superior customer care.
- ♦ Explain the factors to consider when improving customer care.
- ♦ Identify type customers by explaining the range of customers that a officer might encounter during his/her duties.

LEARNER ACTIVITY 1 (page 13)

Explain why the customer is a source of revenue for the organization.

The better the customer care given to customers, the more business they will do with your company and the more business the company generates, the more profit it stands to make. This enables the company to pay competitive salaries and therefore makes good business sense to look after customers as a disciplined practice.

Customers are not dependent on you, you are dependent on them as they pay the salaries and without them businesses have to close down and as a result people would lose their jobs.

When customers make purchases or use services and are parting with hard-earned money, they like to be treated properly, irrespective of their gender, age, race, colour or creed, and will otherwise take their business elsewhere if not.

Keep in mind that you are the link between the outside world and your organization and as first impressions are lasting, it is up to you to make your first impression count.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 2 (page 13)

Discuss the impact of bad customers relations on the company.

The organization that delivers superior customer service will achieve major benefits in competitive advantage and profitability.

Client/customers are your organization's most important assets and the relationship you have with them will be the benchmark by which your site/company is judged in terms of customer focus and quality of service. Their attitudes towards your site/company will depend on the way in which you treat them.

The lack of caring for your client/customers could result in the site/company not reaching its true potential. Caring about your client/customers can create a competitive and harmonious organization as people like dealing with people who care and this results in the client/customers returning generating repeat business and increased profits.

For every bad service a client/customer experiences he/she will tell at least 5 others, who in turn will tell 5 more and soon resulting in 10 people and more having a bad impression of the site/company, which is 10 potential client/customers lost – a loss of income/ turnover for the site/company and decreased profits.

Site/company employees contribute in specific ways to create an overall positive experience for customers. As an employee, you represent the company's image. If your image is professional and personal, then customers will have this image of the company.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 3 (page 15)

List 5 annoying habits that irritate customers.

- ♦ Being ignored and not greeted by staff.
- ♦ Being false and smiling insincerely at a client/customer.
- ♦ Not calling a client/customer by name.
- ♦ To be yelled at.
- ♦ To stand in long, slow-moving queues.
- ♦ People that make no effort whatsoever.
- ♦ Not paying attention to what the client/customer is saying.
- ♦ Keeping client/customers waiting, without acknowledgement, while completing a previous task.
- ♦ To wait for service while you chat on the telephone.
- ♦ Talking to a colleague when dealing with a client/customer.
- ♦ Unhelpful monosyllabic answers, especially "NO".
- ♦ To be served by a person that smokes cigarettes or chews gum.
- ♦ Any negative body language.
- ♦ Play loud music while dining.
- ♦ Cashiers that run out of change.
- ♦ People that don't answer letters or return phone calls.
- ♦ If you run out of basic goods, for example their favorite drink.
- ♦ Confusing signs or directions.
- ♦ Not thanking a client/customer when the transaction has been completed.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 4 (page 16)

Describe 5 guidelines to maintain good customer care.

- ♦ Never show that you are angry or upset when dealing with an angry client/customer. It will make matters worse and you will lose their business.
- ♦ Your client/customers expect reliable and prompt service. If they do not get it from you they will take their business elsewhere. This could jeopardize your job in the organization.
- ♦ Tardiness is not tolerated well by most client/customers; show your respect for them and for their time by always being punctual.
- ♦ Demonstrate high moral values – Don't tell lies, you will lose your integrity and possibly your job by doing so.
- ♦ Create a climate of warmth before client/customers' even approach you.
- ♦ Send out warm and positive signals to each client/customer prior to the start of the interaction.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 5 (page 15)

Discuss the advantages you as the security officer will have when anticipating the customers needs.

Anticipating your client/customers' needs could eliminate unnecessary time and irritation. Pay attention to the client/customer's need and decide how your site/company's service can benefit them:

If you identify products and/or services that the client/customer has not requested, offer to provide the service without requiring the client/customer to ask for it.

Anticipate your client/customer's needs and wants and look for clues in the verbal and non-verbal messages they are giving you. Listen attentively, ask appropriate questions and observe the client/customer's body language

The difference between your customer's needs and wants may be that some client/customers know what they want, or they will have a general idea. Generally, client/customers will often tell you what they want but their needs are not stated so often, e.g. a client/customer may state he/she wants a room with twin beds but he/she may also need an extra pillow for one bed and more blankets.

If you know your site/company well, you are in a good position to help a client/customer. It helps to keep appropriate materials you can refer to close by (e.g. product lists, services offered, tariffs, general tourist information). If you first have to check up on the information, tell the client/customer and remember to contact him/her back with the relevant information.

It can happen that you have a client/customer caller who has been transferred incorrectly to your department. Unnecessary time can be saved if you have anticipated such a situation and know enough about the site/company providing relevant information, providing specific contact names) before redirecting the frustrated client/customer to the correct department.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 6 (page 19)

Customers normally expects more than usual!! How would you react to satisfy the customers expectation.

Each client/customer is important and has the following expectations when making use of your organization:

- ♦ Make me feel important
- ♦ Don't lie to me
- ♦ Keep your promises
- ♦ Give me understandable information
- ♦ Be sensitive to my needs
- ♦ Listen to my advice on improving your service or product
- ♦ Be fair - If I am expected to pay for my service then I expect value for my money
- ♦ Treat me in such a way that I will come back to your site/company
- ♦ Don't underestimate my intelligence, that would be insulting.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

SELF-ASSESSMENT

The learner must make use of the following self-evaluation checklist to rate himself against the learning outcomes of this particular training module in establishing the level of mastery of the information.

1. Not able to comply
2. Reasonable compliance (Not acceptable for final evaluation)
3. Able to comply fully

LEARNING OUTCOMES		1	2	3
1	Explain the importance of the customer.			
2	Explain the impact on the organization and on oneself of losing regular customer business.			
3	Discuss annoying habits that irritates customers.			
4	Explain how the officer can anticipate a customer's needs.			
5	Discuss guidelines that can be followed to maintain good customer care.			
6	Explain methods to maintain good customer service.			
7	List the expectations that customers have from any organization.			
8	Describe possible ways that customers could react to poor service.			
9	Apply and explain the guidelines for superior customer care.			
10	Explain the factors to consider when improving customer care.			
11	Identify type customers by explaining the range of customers that a officer might encounter during his/her duties.			

Evidence Collector Signature

Date

Security Officer Signature

Date

LEARNING UNIT 2

Complaints and problems

- ♦ Explain the advantages of receiving customer complaints.
- ♦ Use the most appropriate method to deal with customer related issues.
- ♦ Identify and explain the range of customer complaints that the officer may encounter during his/her daily duties.
- ♦ Identify common customer complaints.
- ♦ Use methods to satisfy irate customers.
- ♦ Establish customer needs in line with organizational requirements and decide what follow up action to take.
- ♦ Explain how to deal with a customer complaint effectively.
- ♦ Use the correct customer complaints procedure.
- ♦ Deal with a written complaint in line with organizational requirements and decide what follow up action to take.
- ♦ Apply the correct procedure when documenting customer complaints.
- ♦ Demonstrate skills in dealing with a personal complaint of a customer.
- ♦ Demonstrate skills in following up a complaint to take appropriate action.
- ♦ Explain the requirements for superior customer care.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge by understanding when to refer a client.
- ♦ Demonstrate knowledge by explaining the guidelines to build rapport with the customer.

LEARNER ACTIVITY 1(page 25)

It is sometimes good to receive feedback from customers or complaints from customers. Discuss this statement by providing possible advantages of receiving feedback from customer complaints.

Customer complaints offer you an opportunity to rectify a situation resulting in prevention of further complaints and continuous improvement of service. You should react and respond to all complaints to make sure you never receive the same complaint twice. Always endeavor to identify and work to eliminate the cause of the complaint.

Dealing effectively with complaints can result in:

- ♦ Elimination of product or service defects.
- ♦ Improved operating procedures.
- ♦ More skillful customer service behaviour.
- ♦ Higher performance standards.
- ♦ Complaints and customer feedback forces problems out into the open and people have to examine them and work towards a solution.
- ♦ It enables client/customers, as well as the site/company to state their goals and perhaps achieve them.
- ♦ Prevents hostilities and resentments from festering.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 2

CASE STUDY: Read the case study and discuss the most suitable method to deal with the situation. Also discuss at least two other methods that can be used during a conflict situation with a customer.

The sound of thunder and bright flashes in the sky may have been a wonderful spectacle last night, but what I didn't realize was that it would cause one of the worst days of my life. I did not know about the power failure at three this morning because I was fast asleep. The first time I realized that my alarm did not go off, was at $\frac{1}{4}$ past five this morning – which meant that I was going to be late for work. I rushed while getting dressed and did not have time to iron my uniform because I had to run to get the last taxi. In my haste I forgot to put my pocket book in my pocket, and I could not find my shoes, so I wore takies instead.

I actually made it to work, only 7 minutes late. My co-worker that had just finished night shift was not very impressed with me because he still had to do the handover. He was going to miss his taxi and would have to wait at least $\frac{1}{2}$ hour for the next one. Because I felt guilty about coming late, I told him to go – I would read the OB to get the details of the night shift....

It looked like things were eventually settling down to a normal, boring working day. Cars stop, "morning sir", "who are you visiting sir", "that would be at block C – second building on the left", "have a nice day sir". The same thing, over and over. Sometimes I feel like a tape recorder. Cars come, cars go.

In the mean time I'm still a bit unsettled from all the rushing around this morning and tired from lack of sleep because I had to settle the kids down who were crying because they're scared of the thunder and lightning.

Then the blue BMW stops at the gate. He hoots. So I wasn't quite as observant as I am supposed to be – I am tired, you know. I paste my smile on my face and walk up to the driver's window.

I get as far as saying: "Good morning, Sir."

"Good? – good???; so what's good about it?"

"Where is Mr. Brown? It's ten past nine. These \$%# taxis! They caused an accident that has made me late! Open this #%^ boom!"

"Sir", I say, "I have to search your vehicle before you enter." And I think to myself that this guy is so rude - I haven't done anything to him!

[illegible]

[illegible]

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 3 (page 29)

From the case study in the previous learning activity, discuss how would you have determine the needs of this difficult customer.

- ♦ Greet the client/customer: “Good morning, Mr. / Ms. _____”
- ♦ Offer assistance: “How may I help you?”
- ♦ Clarify requirements: Ask for additional information.
- ♦ Confirm action to be taken: Tell the client/customer what you will do
- ♦ Take action: Do what you have agreed to do.
- ♦ Follow-up: Check if the client/customer is satisfied, by asking questions:

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 4 (page 32 & 33)

Complete the attached diagram to provide your understanding of the correct communication skills through body language.

	Body Language	Positively	Negatively
1.	Eye Contact	Eye contact will create the impression that you are interested in them	No eye contact gives an impression of indifference and “I don’t care”.
2.	Stance	Standing with your arms by your side, and facing your customer will create a sense of ease	Standing with your arms folded across your body, is a defensive gesture that suggests you want to distance yourself from the customer.
3.	Posture	An upright posture gives an impression of enthusiasm and creates a caring atmosphere	Slumping against furniture gives the impression of a defeated, depressed, or “I don’t care” attitude.
4.	Facial Expressions	Smile, as it offers friendship	It’s no good telling a customer to “Have a nice day”, when you frown or scowl is just as good as saying “Good-bye and good riddance”.
5.	Gestures	Offering a hand shake	Shrugging your shoulders, tapping your foot, drumming your fingers, wringing your hands

Characteristics of both the positive and the negative of body language

Positive Body Language	Negative Body Language
Looking at the client/customer’s face	Avoiding looking at the client/customer
Making frequent eye contact	Avoiding the client/customer’s eyes or staring aggressively
Nodding and smiling as the other person speaks	Repeatedly licking your lips or clearing your throat
Uncrossing your arms	Keeping your arms folded
Having “open” hands	Clasping your hands tightly together
Steepling your fingers	Banging the table or pointing at the client/customer
If standing, turning towards the client/customer	Standing over the client/customer when seated
Leaning slightly towards the client/customer	Leaning away from the client/customer
Maintaining a relaxed posture	Fidgeting

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 5 (page 36)

Discuss the correct procedure to be followed when receiving customer complaints.

1. Never ignore a complaining client/customer. Give him or her your undivided attention.
2. Listen carefully to the reason for the complaint. If you are not quite sure on the point he/she is making, ask him/her to clarify the complaint.
3. Put yourself in the client/customer's shoes, and use positive and friendly words and comments throughout the conversation.
4. Stay calm and if you feel irritated by the nature of the complaint, don't show it. You won't get very far if you start being aggressive.
5. Ask pertinent questions so that you remain in control of the situation and generate the information required to be of assistance.
6. Record all complaints, however trivial:
 - ◆ Name of customer
 - ◆ Date
 - ◆ Nature of complaint
 - ◆ Action taken
 - ◆ Date complaint is resolved
 - ◆ Any follow-up if necessary
7. Apologize and show the client/customer that you are taking immediate action. E.g. rectify the problem or take down all their details so that you can refer the problem to your manager.
8. Explain to the client/customer how the problem started and that it was not done intentionally. Stick to the facts; don't create false impressions or be dishonest. Don't tell a client/customer her room is being cleaned when you know that the cleaners are still on lunch.
9. When working on a complaint, keep the client/customer informed. Inform the client/customer if there are going to be any delays in solving the matter.
10. Follow the complaint through to its logical conclusion and make sure that the complainant is perfectly happy about everything before you close the matter.
11. Remember, a client/customer's complaint is always valid, no matter how outrageous it is.
12. Mistakes happen and complaints will occur. Don't get depressed by them. Every complaint is an opportunity to demonstrate your commitment and professionalism to your client/customers and that can lead to increased client/customer loyalty.
13. Let the client/customers know that, if they are unhappy about something, they will find it very easy to approach the site/company with their complaint, and that complaint will be attended to promptly.
14. You could say something like: "We're sorry for the inconvenience you have been caused"

[illegible]

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

SELF-ASSESSMENT

The learner must make use of the following self-evaluation checklist to rate himself against the learning outcomes of this particular training module in establishing the level of mastery of the information.

1. Not able to comply
2. Reasonable compliance (Not acceptable for final evaluation)
3. Able to comply fully

LEARNING OUTCOMES		1	2	3
1	Explain the advantages of receiving customer complaints.			
2	Use the most appropriate method to deal with customer related issues.			
3	Identify and explain the range of customer complaints that the officer may encounter during his/her daily duties.			
4	Identify common customer complaints.			
5	Use methods to satisfy irate customers.			
6	Establish customer needs in line with organizational requirements and decide what follow up action to take.			
7	Explain how to deal with a customer complaint effectively.			
8	Use the correct customer complaints procedure.			
9	Deal with a written complaint in line with organizational requirements and decide what follow up action to take.			
10	Apply the correct procedure when documenting customer complaints.			
11	Demonstrate skills in dealing with a personal complaint of a customer.			
12.	Demonstrate skills in following up a complaint to take appropriate action.			
13	Explain the requirements for superior customer care.			
14	Demonstrate knowledge by understanding when to refer a client.			
15	Demonstrate knowledge by explaining the guidelines to build rapport with the customer.			

Evidence Collector Signature

Date

Security Officer Signature

Date

LEARNING UNIT 3

Documentation

- ◆ Demonstrate practical skills in the recording of complaints and problems by completing the necessary documentation.

LEARNER ACTIVITY 1

CASE STUDY: Read the case study below and record the situation on the attached documentation.

- ♦ OB
- ♦ Pocket book
- ♦ Message that needs to be taken
- ♦ Incident report.

Obtain all the necessary information from the case study below. The documentation needs to be complete and contain all the necessary and correct information as outlined in the case study.

The sound of thunder and bright flashes in the sky may have been a wonderful spectacle last night, but what I didn't realize was that it would cause one of the worst days of my life. I did not know about the power failure at three this morning because I was fast asleep. The first time I realized that my alarm did not go off, was at $\frac{1}{4}$ past five this morning – which meant that I was going to be late for work. I rushed while getting dressed and did not have time to iron my uniform because I had to run to get the last taxi. In my haste I forgot to put my pocket book in my pocket, and I could not find my shoes, so I wore takies instead.

I actually made it to work, only 7 minutes late. My co-worker that had just finished night shift was not very impressed with me because he still had to do the handover. He was going to miss his taxi and would have to wait at least $\frac{1}{2}$ hour for the next one. Because I felt guilty about coming late, I told him to go – I would read the OB to get the details of the night shift....

It looked like things were eventually settling down to a normal, boring working day. Cars stop, "morning sir", "who are you visiting sir", "that would be at block C – second building on the left", "have a nice day sir". The same thing, over and over. Sometimes I feel like a tape recorder. Cars come, cars go.

In the mean time I'm still a bit unsettled from all the rushing around this morning and tired from lack of sleep because I had to settle the kids down who were crying because they're scared of the thunder and lightning.

Then the blue BMW stops at the gate about 09:20 . He hoots. So I wasn't quite as observant as I am supposed to be – I am tired, you know. I paste my smile on my face and walk up to the driver's window.

I get as far as saying: "Good morning, Sir."

"Good? – good???: so what's good about it?"

"Where is Mr. Brown? It's ten past nine. These \$%# taxis! They caused an accident that has made me late! Open this #%^ boom!"

"Sir", I say, "I have to search your vehicle before you enter." And I think to myself that this guy is so rude - I haven't done anything to him!

"Never mind about my boot, open this gate, you \$|%&*@& "%&*(%\$(*%\$*0%)@*"

By now I'm getting very upset. Who does he think he is to swear at me and call me names? I'll show him....

"Sir, please get out of your vehicle and open the boot. I will not let you pass until I have searched your vehicle!" I tell him.

"Yes, you *%(%^(%#*% - I'll get out" - he swears at me again. Now he's done it. There's no way that someone insults my mother like that and gets away with it. I will search every inch of his car, and today is the day that he will not pass my boom.

He gets out of the car, and that's the last thing I remember before I see my supervisor's face and feel him shaking me. I am lying on the ground, and the boom is pointing up into the sky with blue BMW paint all over it. My jaw hurts like hell...

In the mean time I remember that I had to tell the supervisor that Mr. Johnson phoned and request a meeting at 11:00 at his office.,

[illegible]

Message book

Incident report**INCIDENT REPORT**

Day/Night: _____ Date: _____ Time: _____

INFORMANT (Print) Name: _____ Co No: _____

Company: _____ Section: _____

Telephone: _____ Extension: _____

NATURE OF REPORT: _____

Summary: (Remember Who, What, When, Where and How) _____

INCIDENT:_____
_____**ACTION TAKEN BY SECURITY:**_____
_____**FURTHER ACTION TAKEN:**_____
_____**RECOMMENDATIONS/COMMENTS:**_____

Copy to client: _____ Date: _____

SELF-ASSESSMENT

The learner must make use of the following self-evaluation checklist to rate himself against the learning outcomes of this particular training module in establishing the level of mastery of the information.

1. Not able to comply
2. Reasonable compliance (Not acceptable for final evaluation)
3. Able to comply fully

LEARNING OUTCOMES		1	2	3
1	Demonstrate practical skills in the recording of complaints and problems by completing the necessary documentation			

Evidence Collector Signature

Date

Security Officer Signature

Date

LEARNING UNIT 4

Communication

- ♦ Define communication.
- ♦ Explain the importance to the organisation and oneself of being able to communicate effectively with internal and external customers.
- ♦ Describe the various ways of communicating in a particular context with supplier, customer and colleagues and explain why these ways are appropriate.
- ♦ Demonstrate skills by communicating effectively in context.
- ♦ Explain way of how the officer can improve his or her communication towards customers.
- ♦ Describe potential barriers to effective communication.

LEARNER ACTIVITY 1 (page 55)

In your own words, explain what communication is:

The communication process takes place when information sent by a person (the sender) is received by a second person/persons (the receiver), decoded and reacted upon.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 2 (page 55)

Discuss why it is important to communicate effectively

Effective communication only takes place when **the reaction of the receiving person is positive**, according to the expectations of the sender. For example, by altering the intonation of the voice a customer may either receive the message that a waiter is really pleased to see and help him or that he is merely another nuisance to be served.

Effective internal and external verbal communication has a **direct effect on a company's image and success** in the following ways:

- ♦ Good, clear, concise communication eliminates time wastage in trying to resolve confusion, errors and conflicts
- ♦ Customers/client/customers/patrons like feeling important and will return and recommend the establishment to others if they are treated with politeness and helpfulness. This promotes return business.
- ♦ Staff with positive attitudes, who speak to each other with respect, reflect a positive company image. This gains customer confidence in the establishment.

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 3 (page 57)

Discuss the following types of communication.

- ♦ External communication
- ♦ Face to face communication with special reference to eye contact, facial expressions, and Posture

- ♦ **External communication**

This refers to communication with an audience or people outside of an organisation.

- ♦ **Face to face communication**

When communicating face-to-face, body language plays a vital role in conveying the appropriate messages.

Eye Contact: In the business culture, it is imperative to make eye contact if one wishes to make a positive impression with client/customers and maintain a relationship based on trust. Consider the following:

- ♦ Maintain eye contact without staring, as this is arrogant and threatening.
- ♦ Avoid blinking too much as this communicates nervousness and can be interpreted as an indication of dishonesty.
- ♦ Try to keep eye level on the same level as the client/customer. Stand if the client/customer is standing. If the client/customer is seated, accommodate this by standing back a little.

Facial Expressions: Be aware of facial expressions when speaking to people. Professional service providers who deliver excellent service have alert, lively and appropriate facial expressions.

Avoid the following facial expressions:

- ♦ **An expressionless or deadpan face** showing no emotion in response to what client/customers say makes them feel uncomfortable. This may be interpreted as boredom, rudeness or indifference.
- ♦ **An arrogant or stern expression** creates the impression of being superior to others.
- ♦ **Grinning continually** makes one look stupid. It creates the impression of misunderstanding what is being said or done. It may also create the impression of being deliberately unhelpful.

Gestures: Head and hand movements are common during speech:

- ♦ Smooth and wide gestures with palms facing upwards, are warm and welcoming. People react positively to friendliness and helpfulness. Client/customers are naturally drawn to people who use calming gestures.
- ♦ Sharp, short gestures with palms facing downwards, are aggressive and negative. People react by wanting to either dispute or avoid. When upset or if there is a need to discuss problems, gestures should be controlled. Problems are never resolved through aggressive gestures.

Posture: The way the speaker stands, sits or walks, indicates a great deal about the speaker's attitude, mood and self-esteem.

A correct posture entails the following:

- ♦ Stand upright with arms comfortably at sides
- ♦ Keep shoulders dropped and slightly back
- ♦ Stand with feet slightly apart to maintain balance
- ♦ Walk briskly because it creates a professional impression
- ♦ Sit upright with shoulders back. Slouching looks lazy
- ♦ When speaking to client/customers, either face them or turn the body slightly sideways towards them
- ♦ Avoid leaning against walls or furniture
- ♦ Avoid folded arms – they create the impression of being shy or arrogant
- ♦ Standing with hands on hips looks arrogant
- ♦ Swinging when speaking to people suggests a lack of self-confidence
- ♦ Resting the face on hands while leaning on counters looks lazy.

Personal space: This refers to the space each person has around him/her and into which intrusions are unwelcome. The exact size of the area around each person differs and depends on a variety of factors including, personality, culture, family background and even the type of sport played.

Shy people usually need a wider personal space than outgoing people do. People instinctively indicate when their space is invaded - they either move away slightly, look uncomfortable, blink their eyes to show their discomfort, or look behind the speaker to avoid eye contact.

[illegible]

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

LEARNER ACTIVITY 4 (page 65)

List four barriers of communication

- ♦ Cultural Differences
- ♦ Roles
- ♦ Ethnocentrism
- ♦ Dress

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
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Comments in support of decision

LEARNER ACTIVITY 5**CASE STUDY:**

Read the following case study and answer the questions:

Nkosi has received bad news. His sister is very sick! He needs to take some leave to help his family, as there is no one to look after her in her last days. Nkosi goes to his supervisor and says: "I must go home. I am needed there."

"Nkosi's supervisor says: "So you want to go home. You can't take leave now, you must wait until George comes back from his holiday."

- ♦ What was the purpose of this communication?

- ♦ Who is the originator?

- ♦ What medium of communication did the originator choose?

- ♦ Did the originator take external factors into consideration that could influence the quality of communication? How do you know that?

- ♦ Could the receiver interpret the communication and respond to or create the change that the originator wanted? Why or why not?

- ♦ From the feedback that the receiver gave the originator, do you think that the message was properly understood? Why or why not?

Which external factors played a role during the feedback process as well as during the original communication process?

Requirements achieved	YES		NO	
Comments in support of decision				

SELF-ASSESSMENT

The learner must make use of the following self-evaluation checklist to rate himself against the learning outcomes of this particular training module in establishing the level of mastery of the information.

1. Not able to comply
2. Reasonable compliance (Not acceptable for final evaluation)
3. Able to comply fully

LEARNING OUTCOMES		1	2	3
1	Define communication.			
2	Explain the importance to the organisation and oneself of being able to communicate effectively with internal and external customers.			
3	Describe the various ways of communicating in a particular context with supplier, customer and colleagues and explain why these ways are appropriate.			
4	Demonstrate skills by communicating effectively in context.			
5	Explain way of how the officer can improve his or her communication towards customers.			
6	Describe potential barriers to effective communication.			

Evidence Collector Signature

Date

Security Officer Signature

Date